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***Refrigerio dei santi. Gioacchino da Fiore e l'escatologia medievale.* By Robert E. Lerner. (Centro Internazionale di Studi Gioachimiti. S. Giovanni in Fiore. Opere di Gioacchino da Fiore, testi e strumenti, 5.) Pp. 243. Rome: Viella, 1995. L. 46,000 (paper). 88 85669 40 9**
***Gioacchino da Fiore. Introduzione all'Apocalisse.* Edited by Kurt-Victor Selge, translated by Gian Luca Potesta. (Centro Internazionale di Studi Gioachimiti. S. Giovanni in Fiore. Opere di Gioacchino da Fiore, testi e strumenti, 6.) Pp. 65. Rome: Viella, 1995. L. 20,000 (paper). 88 85669 43 3**

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These two volumes are major contributions to Joachimite studies. The first volume is a collection of previously published essays by Robert E. Lerner, Professor of History at Northwestern University. Lerner is a pre-eminent interpreter of medieval eschatology, an authority on the exceedingly complex thought of Joachim of Fiore and a scholar who has done as much as anyone in the twentieth century to discover and stress the persistence into the medieval period of a vital strain of millenarianism in western Christian thought. His volume of collected essays is divided into three parts. The first part includes two essays of 'general interest' (one of which is a now-classic article on the period after AntiChrist in medieval thought). The second deals directly with Joachim's chiliasm, his views on the AntiChrist(s) and his interpretation of Melchizedek and its influence. The third part gathers together essays which deal with later developments in medieval eschatology.

The second volume under review here is an excellent critical edition and translation into Italian of one of three rather short introductions to the Apocalypse which seem to have come from the pen of Joachim of Fiore. It is also one of a series of edited texts which, under the sponsorship of the Centro Internazionale de Studi Gioachimiti, will constitute an *opera omnia* of Joachim when completed. Both volumes are highly recommended for specialists in medieval eschatology.

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CHICAGO

KEVIN MADIGAN

The Life of St Edmund by Matthew Paris. Translated and edited (with biography) by C. H. Lawrence. Pp. viii + 184. Stroud: Alan Sutton/Oxford: St Edmund Hall, 1996. £11.99 (paper). 0 7509 1166 2

Edmund Rich, St Edmund of Abingdon (c. 1174–1240), ranks among the least glamorous of the sainted archbishops of Canterbury. He is no martyr like Aelfheah or Becket, no key figure in great movements like Augustine, Theodore or Dunstan, no creative scholar of international reputation like Anselm, just a decent, above-average scholar and teacher and a good man. Hugh Lawrence has long put us in his debt by making this apparently humdrum figure more intelligible. His magisterial study of the saint's life, accompanying his editions of the two *Vitae* and the *Quadriologus*, appeared some thirty-six years ago. He now gives us an excellent, readable translation of Matthew Paris's *Vita*, a substantial biography and commentary of 117 pages, and two appendices, one on the alleged exile of Edmund, the other on the archbishop's itinerary from January 1234 to November 1240. The scholarly apparatus has been cleverly brought up to date: the itinerary, for example, is based on the list of *acta* in Lawrence's earlier work (pp. 303–14) but includes many useful additions and references. There are good